

DECISION READINESS NOTE (DRN-005)

TITLE: PAPER-BASED REPORTING AS FRAGILE INFORMATION CAPTURE IN OPERATIONAL ENVIRONMENTS

Author: Anthony Kabamba

Capacity: Independent Decision-Readiness Practitioner

Affiliation: Personal (non-institutional)

Status: Anonymized | Observational | Non-enforcement

Evidence Basis: Lived Operational Exposure and Ongoing Observation

Date: February, 2026

1. Context

Domain: Operational / Industrial environments

Decision Surface: Capture of field-level information required for operational control and accountability

2. Observed Structural Pattern

- Critical safety and operational data is entrusted to physical, environmentally vulnerable artifacts (e.g., paper checklists, books).
- The capture medium (paper and ink) is vulnerable to the working environment (grease, water, dust, abrasion).
- Data capture creates a single point of failure: if the physical sheet is damaged or misplaced before filing, the information ceases to exist.
- Administrative prerequisites (locating a form, a pen, or a usable writing surface) introduce friction at the moment of reporting.

3. Decision Reframe

The operative decision is not whether reporting is required. The real decision is:

Does the resilience of the information capture tool match the harshness and variability of the operational environment?

4. Decision Failure Mode

Failure Type: Environmental Mismatch (High-Friction Capture)

The system deploys office-grade tools (paper, ink) into field realities characterized by moisture, contamination, movement, and urgency.

It relies on environmental and logistical conditions (dryness, availability, careful handling) that are rarely stable at the point of work, creating a structural barrier to reliable capture.

5. Accountability Consequence

- Individuals are held accountable for gaps in documentation even when the capture mechanism itself is physically compromised.
- Compliance friction (the difficulty of doing the right thing under field conditions) is not surfaced in performance assessment.
- Loss of data due to physical damage or unavailability is frequently misclassified as a failure to report.

6. Decision Readiness Assessment

The system manages form content and completeness but does not reliably manage:

- media durability (survival of the record in situ)
- capture friction (ease of entry under pressure)
- data redundancy at the point of creation

As a result, documentation responsibility exceeds capture resilience.

7. Minimal Diagnostic Question

When a required record is missing or incomplete, can the system demonstrate that the capture medium (form/book), tools, and conditions were physically viable and accessible at the specific location and moment the work occurred?

If not, the system is not decision-ready.